Central Council for Research in Ayurvedic Sciences

Research & Development in Ayurveda

Emerging Global Trends and New Milestones

"Extensive research on Ayurvedic remedies has revealed their usefulness in global healthcare and has led to burgeoning investment trends in the Ayush sector. The Central Council for Research in Ayurvedic Sciences (CCRAS), an apex research body under the Ministry of Ayush, has accomplished numerous milestones in the field of scientific research in Ayurveda. Over the last more than two years, the Council has significantly contributed to mitigating the impact of COVID-19 pandemic with Ayurveda based interventions."

Ayurveda is among the oldest and most relied-upon systems of medicine across the world. In India, a large number of citizens, especially in the rural heartlands of the country, utilise Ayurveda for primary and preventive care. Over the years, the scientific activity around the concepts of Ayurveda has gained significant momentum. Being a premiere research organization in India for scientific research in Ayurvedic sciences, the Central Council for Research in Ayurvedic Sciences (CCRAS) has been taking the lead in accelerating R&D efforts in the domain. The unique concepts of Ayurveda have deep practicalities of philosophical, oriental methodologies and ubiquitous practices providing individualised medical care by taking into account the geographical, social, cultural, and individual diversities. Research is a continuous experimental process. It can be defined as a diligent inquiry or examination or experiment for the purpose of discovering or interpreting facts. The concepts of Ayurveda have profound applications in terms of current health requirements of the society. These unique and distinguishing qualities are among the primary reasons for wide popularity and use of the Ayurveda across the globe.

About CCRAS

The Central Council for Research in Ayurvedic Sciences (CCRAS) is the apex body under the Ministry of Ayush, Government of India, for the formulation, coordination, development, and promotion of scientific research in the field of Ayurveda and allied disciplines. With a robust network of 30 peripheral units, the Council has been carrying out clinical and research activities across the country. A wide range of initiatives has been conceptualised and materialised by this Council whereas ongoing activities include nationwide programs for the welfare of the public through Ayurveda. The Council has been quite successful in making a significant impact on Ayush pharmaceuticals industry with development of popular Ayurvedic formulations such as Ayush-64. These formulations and technologies have earned the Council as many as 17 patents. Through collaborations with leading academic and research institutions including IIT, ICMR, and ICAR, the Council has successfully developed technologies such as Automation of Ksharsutra that potentially impact the lives of people. The Automated Ksharsutra device is developed by CCRAS and IIT, Delhi to overcome the challenges of quality, hygiene, standardisation and production time.

Successfully combating Covid challenges

Ever since the outbreak of the COVID-19 pandemic, the Ministry of Ayush has taken a wide range of initiatives to combat the challenges arising out of the pandemic situation. In an effort to complement the efforts of the Ministry, CCRAS took several measures for the control, prevention, and treatment of COVID-19 by issuing several advisories and guidelines. To curb the incidence of morbidity and mortality, the Council emphasised the use of immunity-promoting interventions from the ancient traditional systems of medicine involving Ayush and home remedies based on traditional knowledge. During this process, Aswagandha emmerged as an prophlatic measure to prtevent the occurance of COVID 19. Furtther, repurposing of Ayush 64 emmerged as stand alone/addon therapy for managment of Covid 19.

With guidance and support from the Ministry of Ayush, the Council has undertaken several R&D and public health initiatives to harness the potential of Ayush systems to contain the impact of the pandemic. The "Council has played a crucial role in implementing the guidelines and advisories issued by the Ministry of Ayush for improving immunity and using simple home remedies. The guidelines also include a set of self-care guidelines duly vetted by eminent Ayurveda experts for preventive health measures, with special reference to respiratory health and enhancing immunity. The Council has also worked on an online mechanism for crowd-sourcing of scientific evidence-based solutions from the Ayush systems to combat the pandemic. It has modified the existing extramural research scheme to support short-term research projects for evaluating the impact of Ayush interventions in the prophylaxis and management of COVID-19. As the COVID-19 challenge is not over yet, CCRAS is committed to evidence-based integration of Ayush systems for public health delivery systems in the best interest of people.

Core R&D Areas

Since its inception in 1969, the Council has been engaged in Clinical Research, Medicinal Plant Research (Medico-Ethno botanical Survey, Pharmacognosy & Cultivation), Drug Standardisation, Pharmacological Research, Literary Research & Documentation, and various outreach activities such as Tribal Health Care Research Programme, Ayurvedic Mobile Health Care Research Programme under Scheduled Castes Sub Plan (SCSP), Swasthya Rakshan Programme, Integration of Ayush (Ayurveda) with National Programme for Prevention and Control of Cancer, Diabetes, Cardiovascular Diseases and Stroke (NPCDCS) and Ayurvedic Health Centres under North East Plan. Besides this, Health care services through Out–Patient Department (OPD) and In-Patient Departments (IPDs), and Special clinics for Geriatric Health care are also provided by the Council. The Council is practically working to transform the research findings into true practice and make them accessible to the needful at large. It has patented several formulations for diseases of national importance through extensive drug development research and has transferred them to industries for public use. Apart from these, the Council has been carrying out a wide range of activities including revival, retrieval, and documentation of Ayurveda and Indian Medical Heritage. CCRAS has also been playing an instrumental role in taking benefits of major government initiatives to people through large-scale programs including diverse research-oriented public healthcare activities and Ayush Wellness Clinics etc.

Collaborative Research

In order to make a meaningful impact on the global health research landscape and to explore new frontiers of scientific research, CCRAS has been leading efforts to cultivate a unique ecosystem of collaborative research at National/International and industrial level. Over the years, alliances with eminent industry and academia partners have yielded significant results in the form of scientific milestones. These milestones have earned the Council a special place among notable research institutions.

Among these scientific achievements, the most notables include - Ayush Manas for mental retardation in collaboration with RML hospital, New Delhi and NIMHANS, Bangalore; Ayush QOL-2C for improvement of quality of life in cancer patients with AIIMS, New Delhi, St. John Bangalore & Bhagwan Mahavir Cancer Hospital, Jaipur;